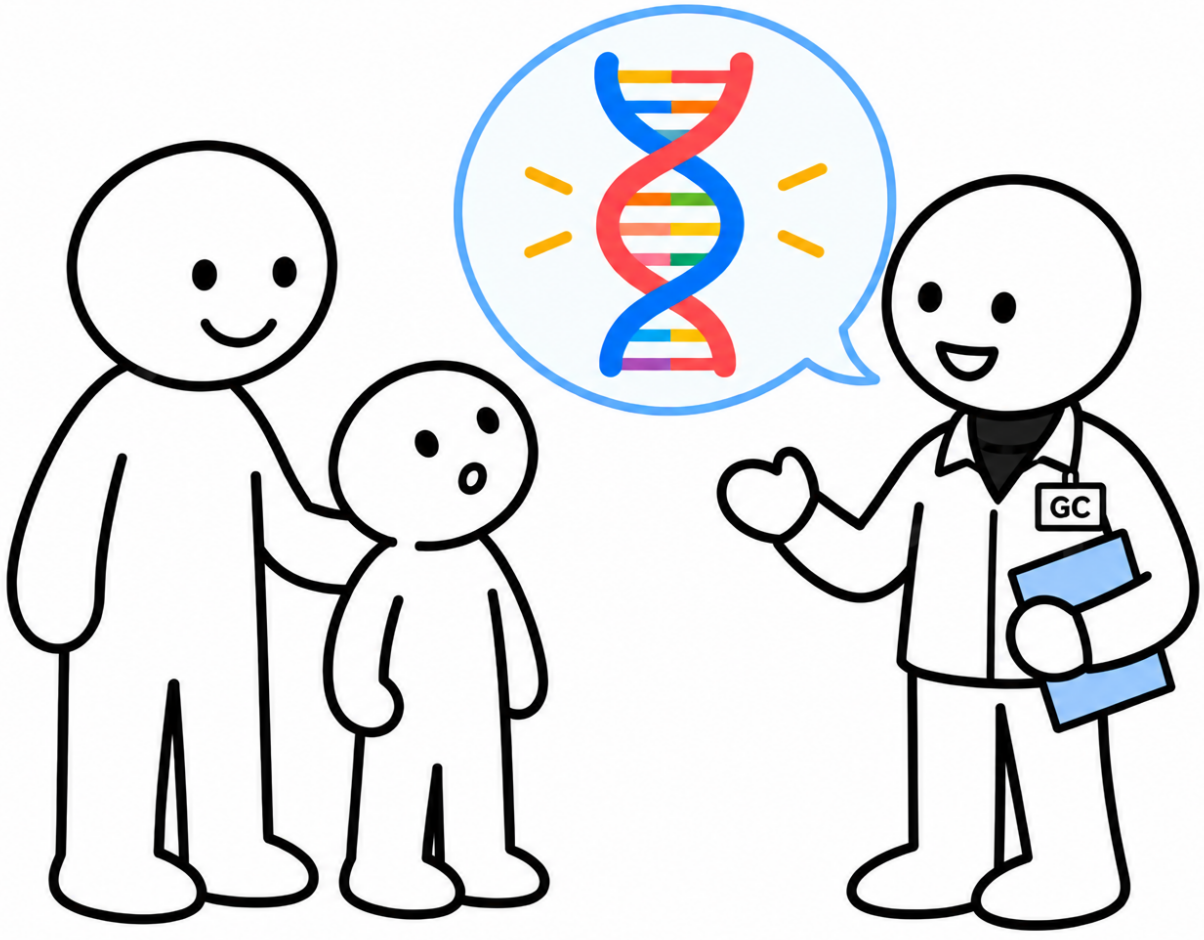
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Genetic Counseling

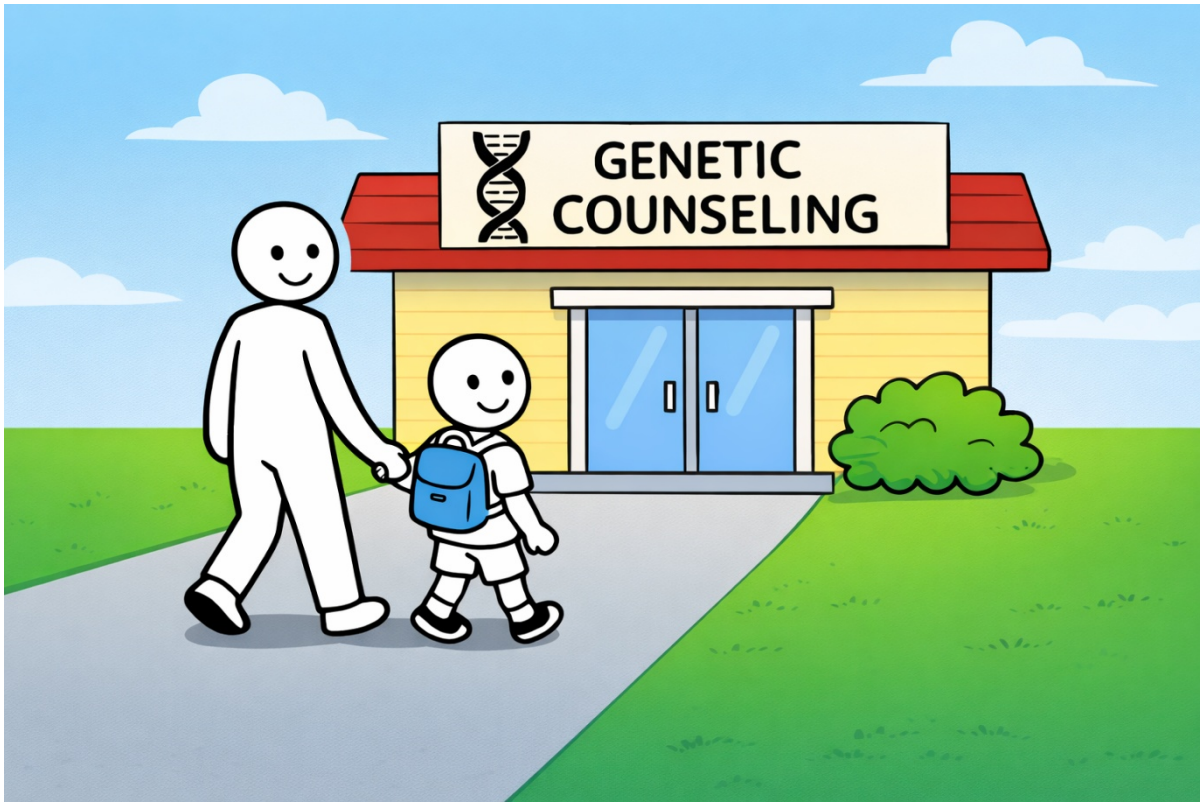


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This is a story about going to a genetic counselor appointment.



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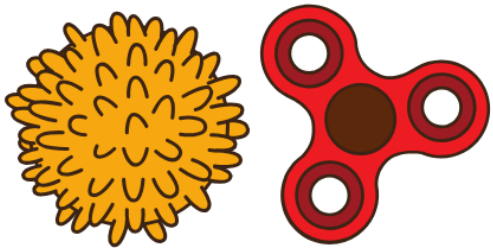
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I can bring my favorite items with me to my appointment!









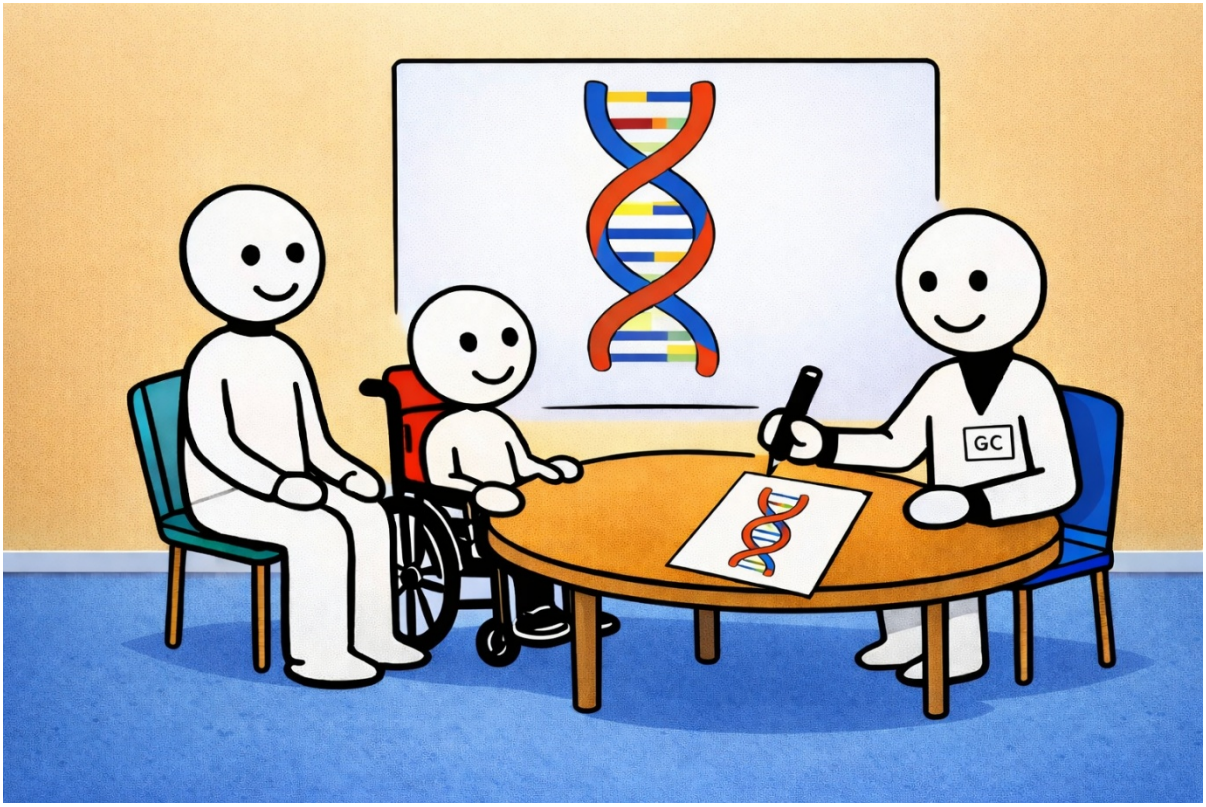


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The genetic counselor will talk to me about my DNA.



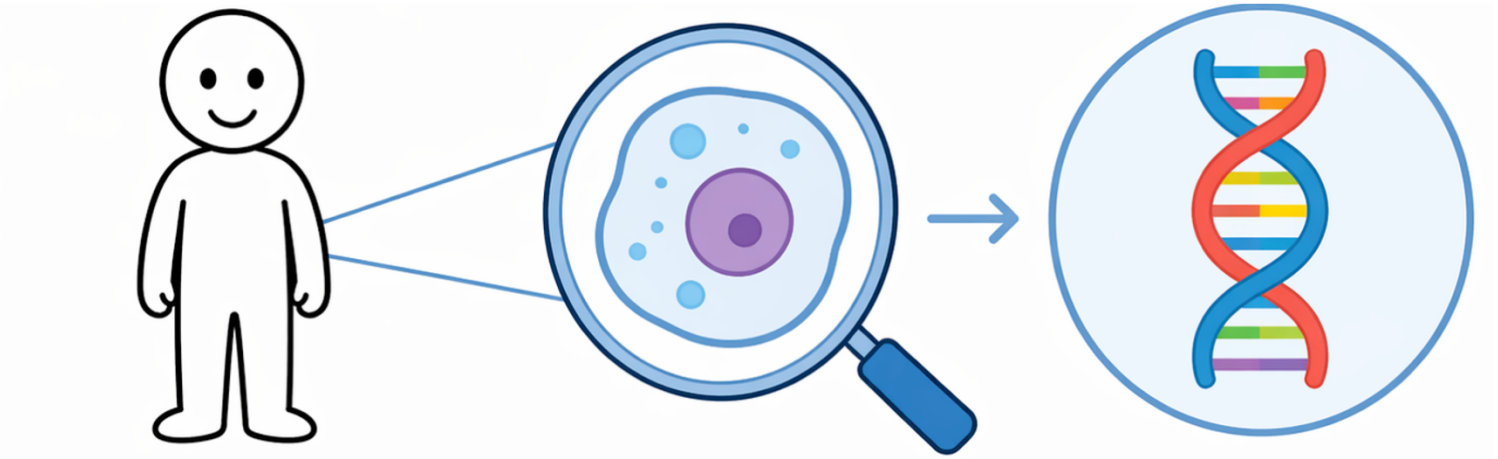
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Our body is made of tiny cells.

DNA is inside those cells.



Body

Cell

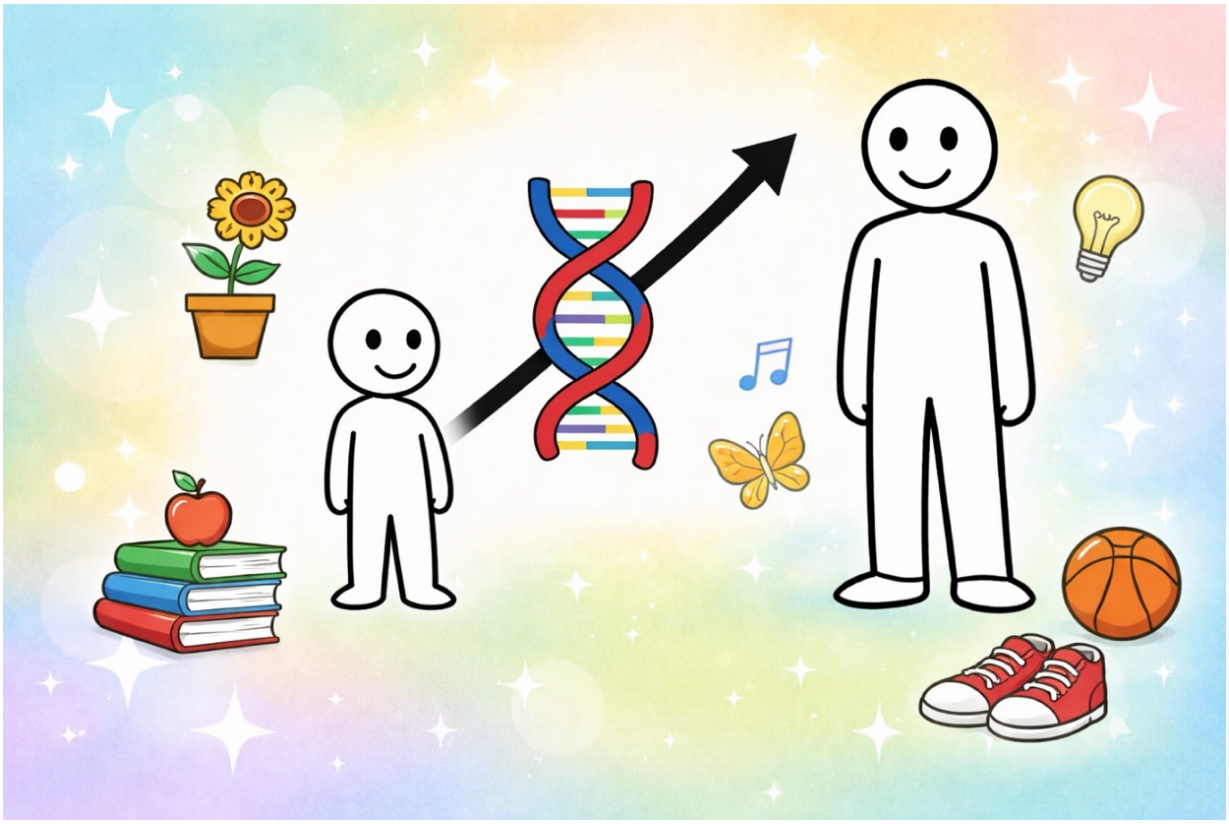
DNA

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DNA helps our body grow!



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The genetic counselor will ask about my family.

- I can answer as best as I can.
- It is okay if I don't know all the answers.



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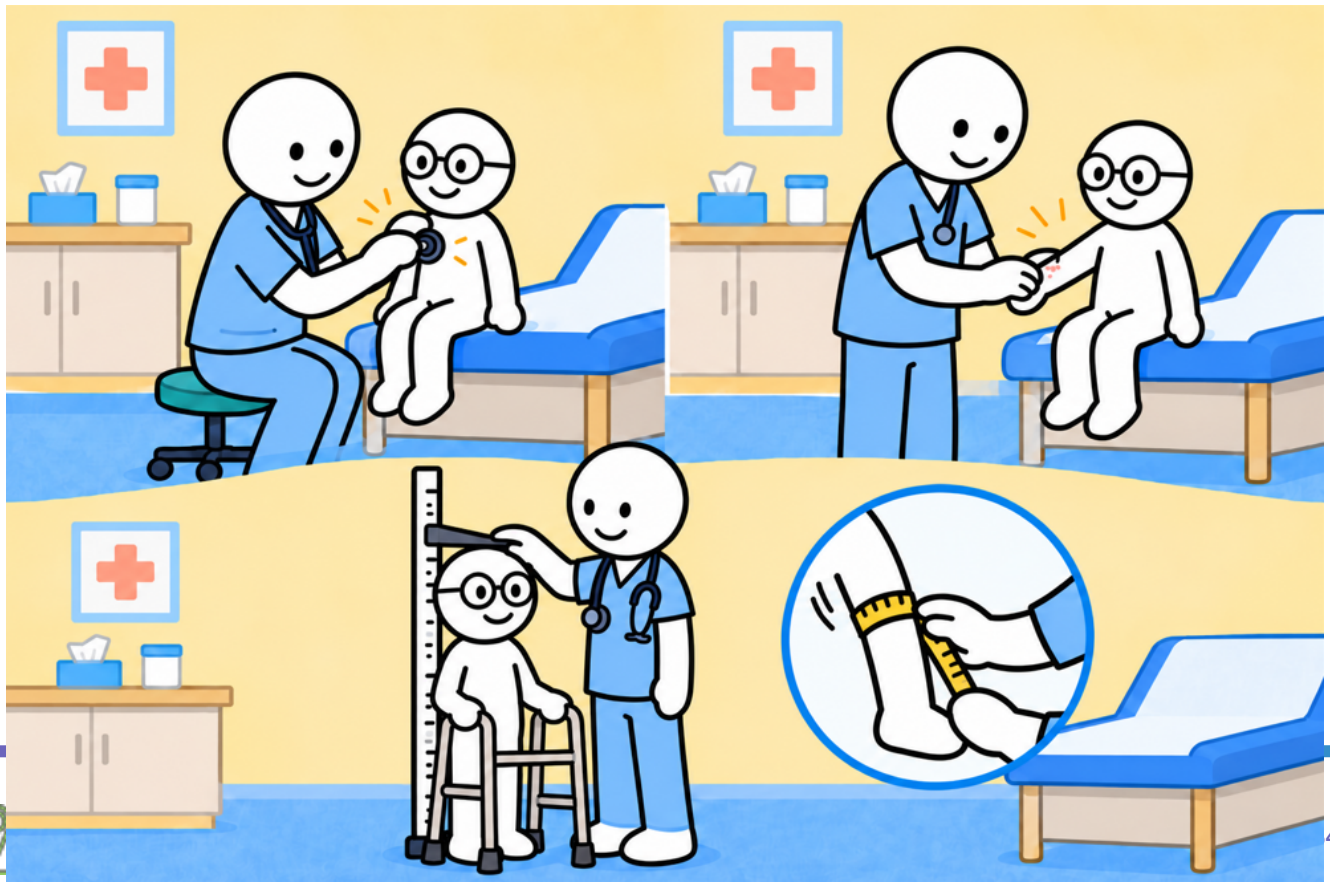
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A nurse or doctor may come in for a check-up.

They will:

- Listen to my heart
- Check my skin
- Measure my body such as my head, arm, or leg.

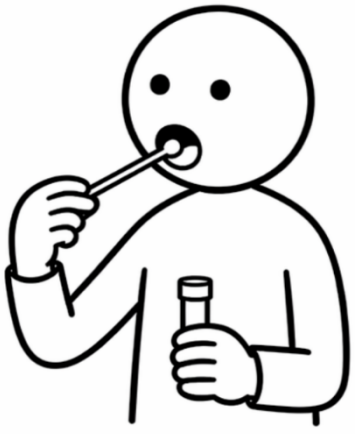
The check-up helps me stay healthy and strong!

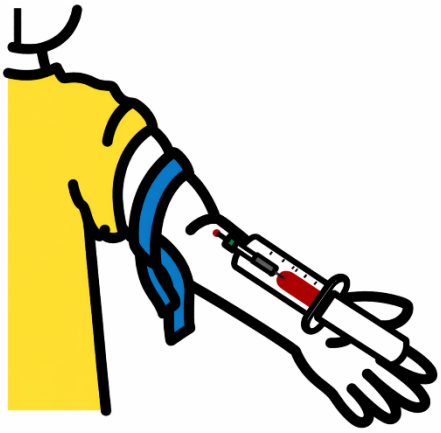


To learn more about my DNA, the genetic counselor will ask for one of these samples to be sent to DNA scientists:

- A cheek swab
- Blood
- Spit

The sample will be taken at the end of the appointment.







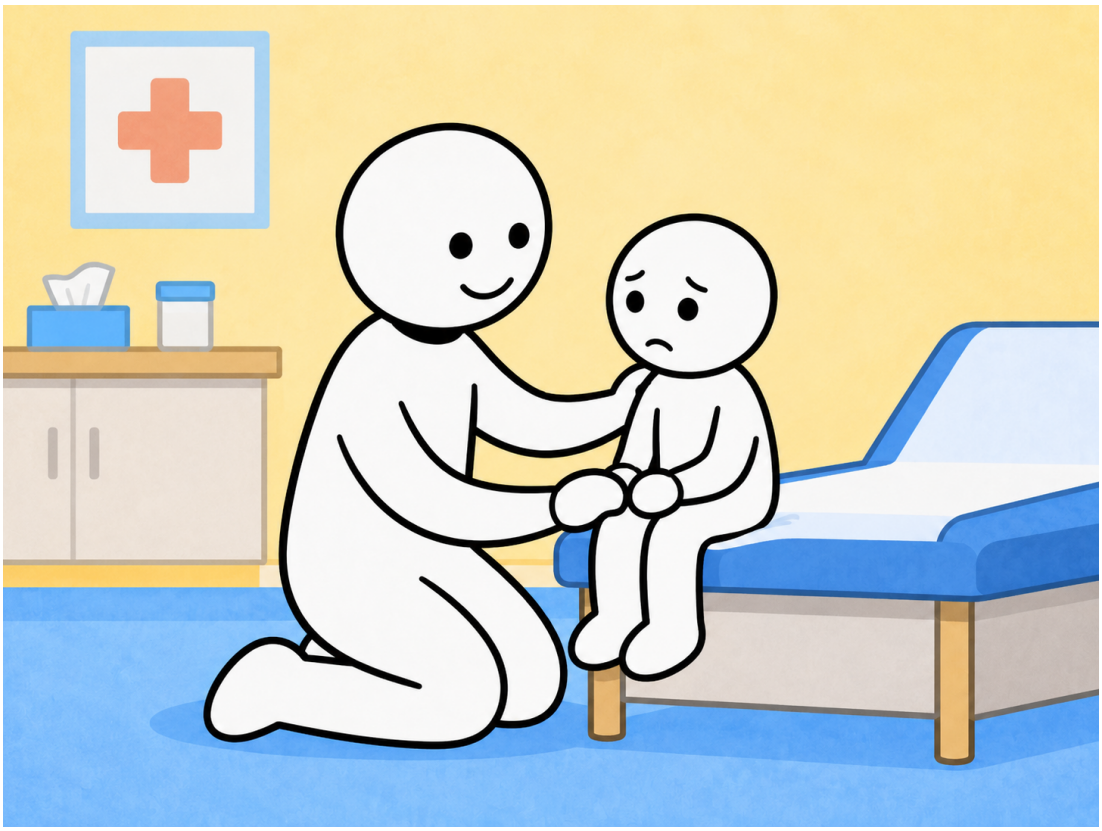
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If I am scared,

I can ask my grown up for help to be brave and calm.



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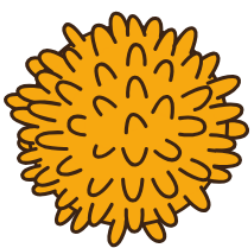
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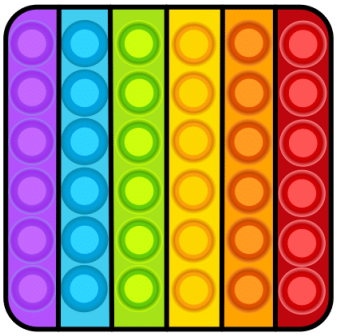
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I can use my favorite toys to help calm me down, too!













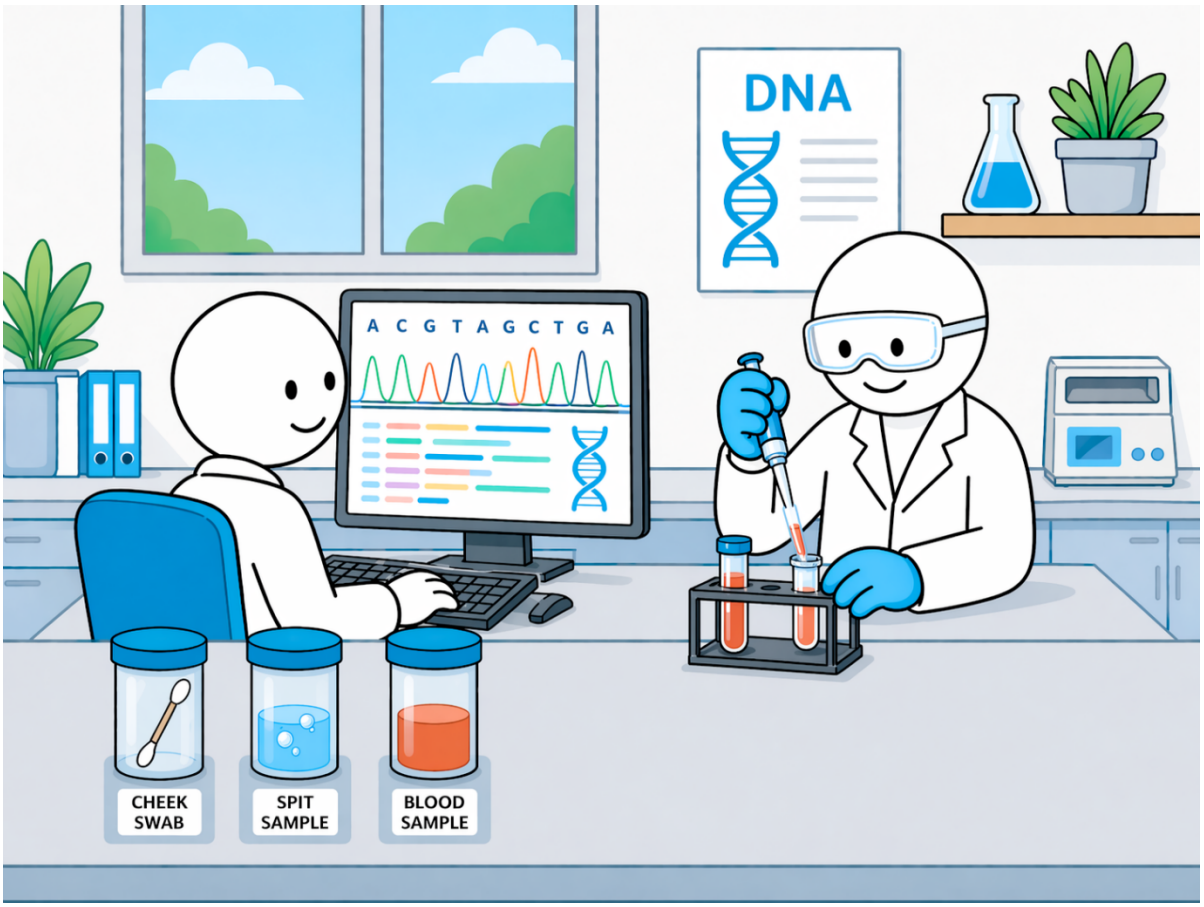
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I can now go home and wait for the DNA scientists to finish.

This can take a few weeks.

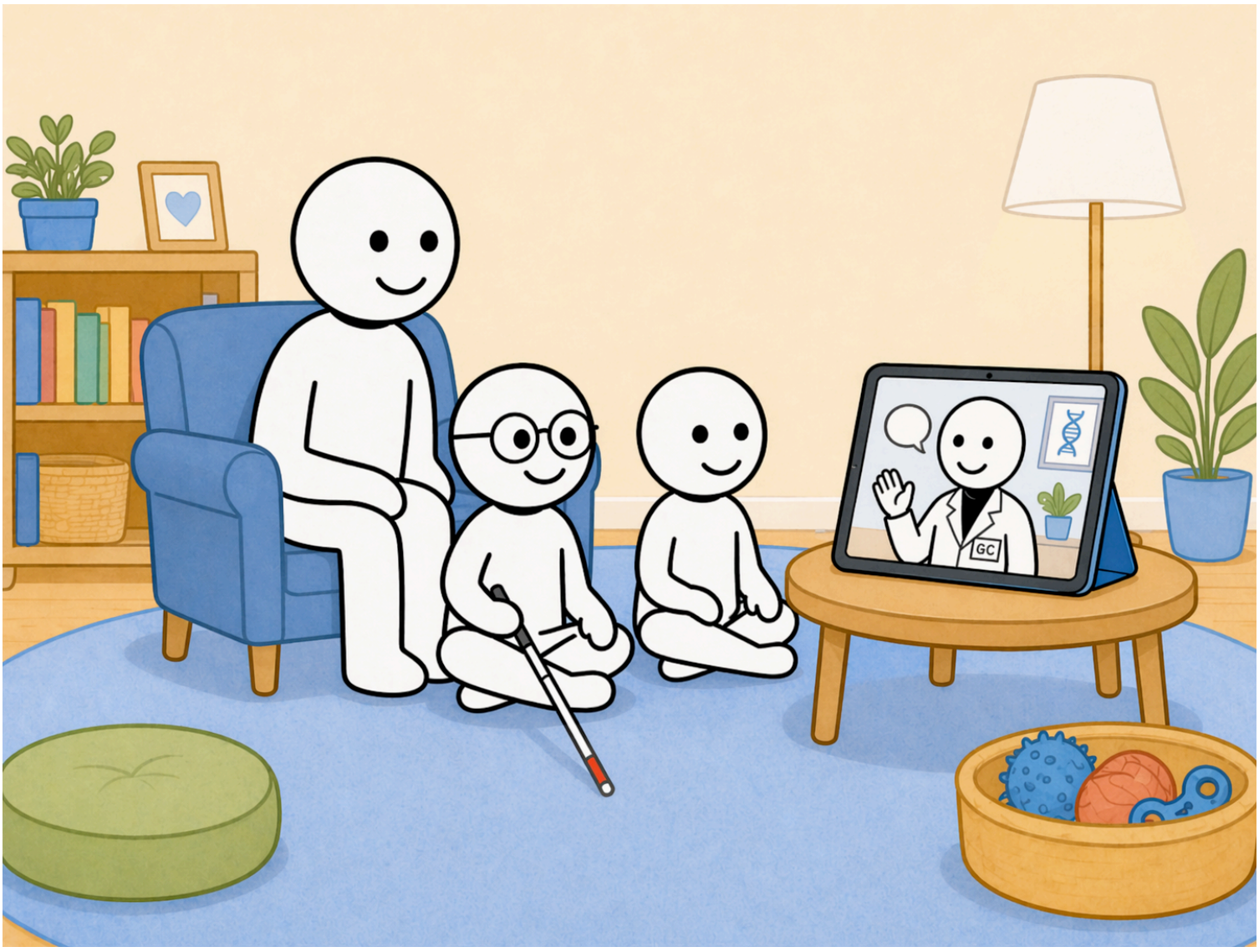


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The genetic counselor will give us a call or we will visit them again to talk about what the DNA scientists found.



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DNA can tell us many things… but who I am is for me to discover!



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I did a great job learning about my genetic counseling appointment!



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